# ODDYSEUS: JOURNEY'S END

Game Design Document

Draft v0.7

### What changed in v0.7

- Map shortened from 13 islands in 3 Phases to 9 islands in 2 Phases (Section 3.2). The old Phase 2 was removed, so the Boss phase is now Phase 2.
- Map generator task updated to match (Section 11.2).

## 1. Concept Overview

**Game Name:** Oddyseus: Journey's End

**Genre:** RPG, Deck/Party-Building, Resource Management, Roguelite, Single Player, Fantasy/Mythological, Turn-Based, Strategy, Replay Value, 2D, Dungeon Crawler

**Premise:** A retelling of Homer's Odyssey. The player takes on the role of Odysseus, leading a party of companions on the long, dangerous voyage home from the fall of Troy to Ithaca. The tone leans into mythic hardship (hunger, mutiny, divine wrath) as much as combat.

**Visual Tone:** The everyday world (regular islands, battles, the crew's day-to-day struggle) is warm and painterly rather than grim: a gouache-style illustrated look, lived-in and hard-won but not suffocating. Encounters with gods and entry into their domains are a deliberate, vivid colour break: same gouache-painterly style, but suddenly more saturated and dramatically lit (e.g. Aeolus's floating sky island, Athena's mind-palace). This is a recurring pattern: every major god/mythic-figure encounter gets its own vividly coloured realm, a visual reward the player learns to recognize. See Section 4.1.

**Players:** Single Player

## 2. Technical Specs

| Spec | Value |
|---|---|
| Engine | Unity |
| Language | C# |
| Technical Form | 2D |
| View | Side-view with characters in fixed portrait slots, like Limbus Company (not a spatial/tactical grid). Selecting a character opens a pop-up below showing their attack/skill options. |
| Platform | PC, Android |

| Spec | Value |
|---|---|
| Device | PC, Mobile |

*Note: earlier drafts listed C++/Ruby/Java and iOS/Mac/Console as well. Trimmed to the confirmed Unity/C#, PC+Android scope. Flag if any should return (e.g. iOS as a later port).*

# 3. Game Modes

The game has two distinct modes that share a character roster but almost nothing else in structure.

## 3.1 Campaign Mode

- A fixed, authored retelling of the Odyssey, structured episodically in the style of Limbus Company, released and expanded over time (cadence TBD). Milestone target: reach the first encounter with Poseidon, following the story of Odysseus the Epic Musical.
- The player controls a full party of 4 characters through scripted story chapters, starting at Troy.
- Navigation is via a map/chapter-select UI, unlocking sections as the story progresses.
- Combat follows the speed-based, fixed-slot party battle system (Section 5).
- No resource management in this mode. The focus is team composition and skill loadouts against fixed encounters.
- Losing a battle simply allows a retry, with no run-ending consequence.
- Completing campaign chapters is the only way to unlock characters for Dungeon Mode (no gacha, no leveling grind). See the chapter table below and Section 5.3.
- God Realms appear here as scripted, non-selectable story beats tied to specific chapters (Section 4.1).

**Campaign chapters (initial release scope)**

| Chapter | Story | Unlocks |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Troy: Odysseus's Trojan Horse plan. | Eurylochus, Diomedes, Epeius |
| 2 | Cyclops Island: the cave of Polyphemus. | Polites, Perimedes |
| 3 | Wind God Island: Aeolus and the bag of winds (God Realm). | Elpenor, Eurybates |
| 4 | First meeting with Poseidon (God Realm). Milestone end of the initial release. | TBD (see Section 10) |

## 3.2 Dungeon Mode (Roguelite)

A Slay the Spire-style free-range version of the same journey, where the player charts their own course home to Ithaca. The player picks a party from their unlocked roster, chooses a Map, and threads across its islands.

**Map structure (replaces the earlier 3 Maps / 2 Phases / 6 islands figures).**

- A Map is one leg of the voyage and contains 9 islands, divided into 2 Phases.

| Phase | Islands | Contents |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | 4 | Islands 1 to 3 are random: Battle, Event or Resource. Island 4 is a Rest Stop. |
| 2 (Boss phase) | 5 | Islands 5 to 7 are random, island 8 is a Rest Stop, island 9 is the Boss of the chosen Map. |

- Each Map has 2 boss variants.
- Content target: at least 9 Maps, which means 18 different bosses. Bosses can be drawn from the Campaign or the source story.
- A Rest Stop appears after every 3 islands (islands 4 and 8), so each Map has 2 Rest Stops.
- Compared with the earlier 13-island layout, a Map is about 30% shorter, which lowers content and testing load.

**Rest Stop (islands 4 and 8).** The player chooses one of two options:

- Rest: recover HP and Stamina (Stamina recovery at a Rest Stop is 1 point).
- Shop: buy Boons or Equipment (permanent or temporary power-ups, in the style of Limbus Company or Slay the Spire), buy Blessings with Gold (Section 6.2), and buy resources such as Food for the crew.
- God Realms can appear as a selectable node type on the island map (Section 4.1).
- Three island types (Section 4).
- Two managed resources: Men and Food (Section 6).
- Multiple endings, determined by crew surviving and events resolved during the run (Section 7).
- Character HP carries over between battles for the whole run. There is no automatic full heal, only what resource management provides.

*Note: the 9-island, 2-Phase structure is confirmed. The island-by-island layout of each of the 9 Maps is still to be designed.*

# 4. Island Types (Dungeon Mode)

| Island Type | What Happens There |
|---|---|
| Battle Island | A combat encounter using the party-battle system (Section 5). Outcomes affect HP, Men, Food and possibly Gold. The environment changes per encounter (see variants below). |
| Event Island | A dialogue-choice encounter of up to about 4 exchanges. The choice can help or hurt (resources, HP, unlocks). |
| Resource Island | Framed as a narrative choice. Always resolves to one of 3 hidden options: (1) Food only, safe; (2) Food+ at the cost of some HP; (3) Food++ at the cost of HP and Men. The player only sees the story framing. |

*Note: Puzzle Island (riddles, Siren patterns, Aeolus constellations) was removed in v0.6 to reduce scope. It can return after the first release if time allows.*

### Battle Island: environment variants

| Variant | Myth Basis | Feel |
|---|---|---|
| Open Sea | Ship-to-ship skirmishes, storms, Poseidon's wrath, Scylla and Charybdis. | Ship deck, waves and spray, unstable footing. |
| Coastal Raid | Cicones at Ismaros, Laestrygonian giants hurling boulders. | Beach or harbor, enemies on higher ground. |
| Cave / Underground Lair | Polyphemus the Cyclops. | Claustrophobic, torchlit, ambush framing. |
| The Underworld | Tiresias and the shades of the fallen. | Pale, spectral backdrop, ghostly enemies. |
| Open Wilds | Circe's Aeaea, Helios's cattle-land Thrinacia. | Outdoor daylight, least dangerous-feeling. |

*Note: open sky / storm-front combat tied to Aeolus is delivered through God Realms, not as a Battle Island variant.*

### 4.1 God Realms: Special Colour Encounters

Separate from the 3 standard island types, certain moments transport the player into a God Realm: a distinct, vividly coloured location tied to a specific god or mythic figure.

- In both Campaign and Dungeon Mode, any Map or chapter that passes through a god's island leads into that god's God Realm.
- God Realm enemies are harder than standard enemies: they carry Boons or Blessings from the god.
- The background is unique and does not reuse standard island backdrops, so the realm feels special.
- Gods are not playable characters. They appear as NPCs, bosses and Blessing sources only.
- Examples so far: Aeolus's floating island in the sky; Athena's mind-palace (an abstract, surreal interior).
- Visual treatment: same gouache-painterly style, but more saturated and dramatically lit. Each god gets its own palette (Aeolus: stormy blue/violet with gold wind-currents; Athena: cool marble-white with bronze/gold owl-motif). Palette per additional god is TBD.
- Implementation: coders support both a selectable Dungeon Mode map-node variant and a scripted Campaign sequence variant.
- Scope for the current milestone: not a priority. The immediate target is Campaign up to the first Poseidon encounter and at least 9 Dungeon Maps.

## 5. Combat System

Applies to both Campaign and Dungeon modes.

- Party size: 4 characters.
- Turn order: speed-based initiative (like Darkest Dungeon / Honkai: Star Rail), interleaved by each unit's Speed stat.
- On a turn the player picks the character, then a skill, then a target.
- Character HP is individual, not shared.

- Death is permanent within a Dungeon Mode run unless revived by a specific island Event.

**Stamina (Dungeon Mode only; no effect in Campaign except in dungeon-style story segments).**

- Each character has 2 stamina points (replaces the earlier 2 to 3 bars).
- One point is spent each time that character is fielded in a battle. At 0 stamina the character cannot be fielded until recovered.
- Recovery: a character not sent to battle at a Battle Island or battle node recovers 1 point.
- Recovery: choosing Rest at a Rest Stop (after every 3 islands) recovers 1 point.

## 5.1 Roles

- DPS: primary damage dealer
- Healer: restores party HP
- DoT Applier: inflicts damage-over-time
- Buffer/Debuffer: enhances allies or weakens enemies
- Tank: absorbs damage, protects the party

## 5.2 Skills

Every character has a pool of 8 skills but equips 4 at a time: 1 core-role offense skill, 1 secondary core-role skill, 1 base skill, 1 defense skill. Players choose which 4 of the 8 to bring into a fight.

## 5.3 Playable Roster and Unlocks

Mortal characters only. Characters are unlocked by clearing Campaign chapters, then become available for Dungeon Mode parties. Roles are proposals for Game Design to confirm; details are drawn from the Odyssey and may vary by source.

| Character | Story basis | Role (proposed) | Unlocked by |
|---|---|---|---|
| Odysseus | Protagonist, king of Ithaca. | Buffer/Debuffer | Available from the start |
| Eurylochus | Second-in-command of the crew; often questions Odysseus's orders. | Tank | Chapter 1 |
| Diomedes | Greek hero and Odysseus's partner in raids; one of the men in the Horse. | DPS | Chapter 1 |
| Epeius | Builder of the Wooden Horse. | Healer (field repairs) | Chapter 1 |
| Polites | Odysseus's most trusted companion. | DPS | Chapter 2 |
| Perimedes | Member of Odysseus's crew. | DoT Applier | Chapter 2 |
| Elpenor | The youngest and most careless of the crew. | DPS (glass cannon) | Chapter 3 |
| Eurybates | Odysseus's herald. | Buffer/Debuffer | Chapter 3 |

*Note: Telemachus and Circe were removed from the first roster: Telemachus stays in Ithaca during the voyage, and Circe is outside the 4 chapter scope. Either can be added later. Dungeon Mode starts with only the characters unlocked so far.*

### 5.4 Affinity System and Synergy

Affinities are tied to real relationships in the Odyssey (comrades, crewmates, narratively bonded groups). Fielding an affinity group grants a Synergy: extra stats or secret moves unavailable otherwise. A Synergy has only 2 variations: a pair (2 characters) or a trio (3 characters).

| Synergy | Members | Effect |
|---|---|---|
| Brothers in Arms | Polites + Eurylochus | Both gain Defense. |
| Doubt in the Ranks | Odysseus + Eurylochus | Attack up, but stamina is used up faster (follows their conflict in the story). |
| Night Raiders | Odysseus + Diomedes | Speed up; critical chance up on the first turn of a battle. |
| Dearest Companion | Odysseus + Polites | Polites's attack rises while Odysseus's HP is low. |
| Herald's Word | Odysseus + Eurybates | Buffs and debuffs last 1 turn longer. |
| Watch Over the Young | Perimedes + Elpenor | Elpenor gains Defense; Perimedes's damage-over-time effects are stronger. |
| Crew of Ithaca | Odysseus + Polites + Eurylochus | Small bonus to the whole party. |
| Hidden in the Belly | Odysseus + Epeius + Diomedes | Strong attack bonus for the whole party on the first round of each battle (the Wooden Horse ambush). |
| Under the Rams | Odysseus + Polites + Perimedes | Damage taken is reduced while the party's HP is low (the escape from the Cyclops's cave). |

*Note: draft. Effects and numbers are examples to be balanced by Game Design.*

## 6. Resource Management (Dungeon Mode only)

| Resource | Behavior |
|---|---|
| Men | Fixed at the start of the run and never increases. The crew needed to row the boat. Reaching 0 ends the run. |
| Food | Consumable, gained/spent during the run. A modifier resource, not a fail-state counter. |
| Gold | Earned during the run, spent on Blessings and in the Shop. |

### 6.1 Food and HP Interaction

- Entering a Battle Island without food: party loses 10% of max HP.

- Entering a Battle Island with sufficient resources: party regenerates 5% of max HP after the battle.
- Because HP carries over, poor resource management compounds.

### 6.2 Blessings

Divine buffs bought with Gold at the Divine Shop or a regular Shop. Every Blessing is single-use, gives a massive buff, then drains the target's Stamina. Gods are not playable; they only provide Blessings as items. A god who appears as a boss (such as Poseidon) does not sell Blessings.

| God | Effect | Target | Gold |
|---|---|---|---|
| Apollo | Large heal | 1 character | 80 |
| Athena | Speed up; reveals the next island type | Party | 100 |
| Ares | Large Attack boost | 1 character | 90 |
| Hephaestus | Large Defense boost | 1 character | 90 |
| Artemis | Higher crit chance; attacks cannot miss | 1 character | 80 |
| Demeter | Adds Food and boosts HP regen | Party | 70 |
| Hermes | Character acts first in the turn order | 1 character | 60 |
| Zeus | Imbue weapon of party members with lighting | Party | 150 |

*Note: draft. Gold prices are initial estimates for balancing.*

## 7. Win / Lose Conditions

### Dungeon Mode

- Win: traverse the chosen Map to the end and reach Ithaca.
- Lose: Men reach 0. The run ends immediately.
- Losing an individual battle does not end the run, but casualties, HP loss and resource cost carry forward.

**Endings**

| Ending | Condition |
|---|---|
| Normal | Some of the crew survive and reach Ithaca with Odysseus. |
| True | Only Odysseus reaches home (follows the myth). |
| Good (hardest) | The entire crew reaches home alive. |
| Secret (proposal) | Odysseus takes too long; his family dies; he fights the old gods to get them back. Proposed trigger: a hidden "Time at Sea" counter that rises when the player passes Rest Stops or uses Blessings often. Past a threshold, the final Map switches to a secret route where Odysseus faces a Titan such as Cronus as the "old god". Pending approval. |

*Note: numeric thresholds for each ending (how many crew count as "some", the Time at Sea limit) are still to be set by Game Design.*

### Campaign Mode

- Win: clear the chapter/encounter.
- Lose: losing a battle prompts a retry with no permanent consequence.

## 8. Controls / UI

- Input: point-and-click (mouse on PC, tap on Android). No twitch input.
- Combat flow: wait for a character's turn, select character, select skill, select target.
- Dungeon map: point-and-click node selection, similar to Slay the Spire.
- Campaign: map/chapter-select UI in the Limbus Company style.
- Controller support: out of scope.

## 9. Key Features (draft)

- A retelling of the Odyssey with a real sense of a doomed voyage home.
- No gacha, no grinding. Characters are earned through story completion and mastery comes from strategy.
- Two ways to experience the journey: a scripted campaign and a punishing, resource-starved roguelite.
- Permanent consequences within a run (character death, dwindling crew).

*Note: voicelines and music are on the wishlist, pending a scope and budget answer for VO and composition.*

## 10. Open Questions / TBD List

Still open after this pass:

- Chapter 4 unlock: no new playable character yet. Candidates: Telemachus (as a later reward) or a character added after the first release.
- Confirm roles and 8-skill pools for the 8 characters; confirm whether Telemachus and Circe return later.
- Secret Ending: approve or change the proposed Time at Sea / Titan route.
- Ending thresholds: exact crew counts and Time at Sea limit.
- Balance pass on Blessing effects and Gold prices, and Synergy numbers.
- Island-by-island layout for each of the 9 Maps and assignment of 18 bosses.
- Campaign update cadence (how often new chapters ship).
- Whether iOS/Mac/other platforms return as later targets.
- God Realm palette per god beyond Aeolus and Athena.

*Note: resolved this pass: Campaign split into 4 chapters, first roster and unlock order, Synergy list without gods, stamina rules, Rest Stop contents, Map/Phase/island structure, Blessing list, first Synergy list, ending logic, God Realm definition.*

# 11. Task Distribution & Production Order

Team: 2 to 3 Coders, 2 Game Designers, 1 Artist, 1 Sound Designer. Priority order: core gameplay loop, then Dungeon Mode minimally playable, then Story/Campaign Mode. The plan is written by responsibility, not by name; assign people to roles as fits the team. Project period: 15 September to 23 December 2026.

## 11.1 Why This Order

Dungeon Mode exercises almost every core system at once (combat, resources, HP persistence, stamina, map navigation) in a self-contained loop, so it gives the team something testable early. Campaign reuses the combat system but needs narrative content that takes longer to produce.

## 11.2 Task List with Deadlines

*"Gantt" means the date comes from the project Gantt chart. "Proposed" means the date was set for tasks that are not in the Gantt chart yet.*

| Task | Owner (role) | Deadline | Date source |
|---|---|---|---|
| Combat system: fixed slots, speed-based turns, skill/target flow, pop-up menu | Programmer A | 13 Oct 2026 | Gantt |
| Systems/state: Men, Food, Gold, Stamina (2-point rules), HP persistence, 10%/5% rule, save | Programmer B | 20 Oct 2026 | Proposed |
| Milestone: Playable Game (Core Loop) | All | 20 Oct 2026 | Gantt |
| Map generator: 9 islands in 2 Phases, boss node, Rest Stop, island routing | Programmer C (or A/B if only 2 coders) | 27 Oct 2026 | Proposed |
| Map node icons and basic UI frame | Artist | 20 Oct 2026 | Proposed |
| Island types and map icons (finished) | Artist + Programmer C | 27 Oct 2026 | Gantt |
| Odysseus and Men designs and portraits | Artist | 27 Oct 2026 | Gantt |
| Roster of 8 characters: roles, 8-skill pools, role balance (Section 5.3) | Designer 1 | 27 Oct 2026 | Proposed |
| Blessing and Shop data (Section 6.2), Boon and Equipment list | Designer 2 | 27 Oct 2026 | Proposed |
| Sound stage 1: map ambient loop, combat SFX, win/lose stingers, UI sounds | Sound Designer | 27 Oct 2026 | Proposed |
| Final Synergy data tied to final roster | Designer 1 | 31 Oct 2026 | Proposed |
| Decide Secret Ending and ending thresholds | Designer 2 | 31 Oct 2026 | Proposed |
| Project Checkpoint | All | 31 Oct 2026 | Gantt |
| Implement Blessings, Shop, Synergy and ending logic in game | Programmers A, B, C | 10 Nov 2026 | Proposed |

| Task | Owner (role) | Deadline | Date source |
|---|---|---|---|
| Sound stage 2 (Dungeon): 5 Battle ambients, Rest Stop/Shop, Event and Resource stingers, Blessing sting, resource feedback | Sound Designer | 10 Nov 2026 | Proposed |
| Sound stage 3 (Campaign): main menu theme, 4 chapter themes, generic boss theme, Polyphemus and Poseidon themes | Sound Designer | 24 Nov 2026 | Proposed |
| Sound stage 4 (God Realm and endings): Aeolus and Poseidon realm themes, 4 ending stingers | Sound Designer | 8 Dec 2026 | Proposed |
| Sound stage 5: mixing, loop points, file compression for Android | Sound Designer | 15 Dec 2026 | Proposed |
| Campaign Chapter 1: Troy (Trojan Horse) | Designers | 3 Nov 2026 | Proposed |
| Campaign Chapter 2: Cyclops Island | Designers | 10 Nov 2026 | Proposed |
| Campaign Chapter 3: Wind God Island (Aeolus) | Designers | 17 Nov 2026 | Proposed |
| Campaign opening narrative complete (Chapters 1 to 3) | Designers | 17 Nov 2026 | Gantt |
| Campaign Chapter 4: first meeting with Poseidon (same milestone as the Poseidon encounter) | Designers | 24 Nov 2026 | Gantt |
| Poseidon character art | Artist | 17 Nov 2026 | Gantt |
| Chapter-select UI and story-flag system | Programmer (shared tech with Event dialogue) | 17 Nov 2026 | Proposed |
| Poseidon encounter (God Realm) | Designers, Programmer, Artist | 24 Nov 2026 | Gantt |
| Dungeon content: 9 Maps and 18 bosses, Events | Designers + Artist | 1 Dec 2026 | Proposed |
| Aeolus and Athena execution (character and environment art) | Artist | 8 Dec 2026 | Gantt |
| Testing and polish | All | 15 Dec 2026 | Gantt |
| Final Submission and Playtest | All | 23 Dec 2026 | Gantt |

## 11.3 Sound Design Scope

Five stages ordered by project deadline. One sound designer cannot cover everything, so stages are marked by priority.

| Stage | Deliverables | Deadline | Priority |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1. Foundation | Map ambient loop; combat SFX (hit, skill cast, death); win/lose stingers; UI sounds (click, confirm/cancel, skill pop-up, turn change). | 27 Oct 2026 | Required |
| 2. Dungeon Mode | Ambient loops for 5 Battle variants (sea, coast, cave, Underworld, wilds); Rest Stop/Shop music and purchase sound; Event and Resource outcome stingers; Blessing "divine moment" sting; feedback for Men lost, Food out, stamina depleted. | 10 Nov 2026 | Required |
| 3. Campaign | Main menu theme (17 Nov); one theme per chapter (Troy, Cyclops, Wind God, Poseidon); a generic boss theme plus dedicated themes for Polyphemus and Poseidon. | 24 Nov 2026 | Stretch |
| 4. God Realm and endings | Realm themes for Aeolus (stormy, wind) and Poseidon (sea/plague); short stingers for the 4 endings. | 8 Dec 2026 | Stretch |
| 5. Finalization | Volume balance, loop points, file compression for Android. | 15 Dec 2026 | Required |

- 18 bosses do not each need a theme: one generic boss theme with short variations is enough.
- Per-god Blessing variations, full voice-over and a full score remain on the wishlist.
- All sound dates are proposals; they are not yet in the Gantt chart.

## 11.4 Standing Notes

- Role assignments stay internal. Fill in names against each role when the team confirms.
- Voice-over and a full music score remain a later-phase concern; the early audio only needs enough sound that the slice does not feel silent.
- Every "left to design" item in Section 10 is owned by Designer 1 (roster, Synergy) or Designer 2 (Blessings, endings, content).